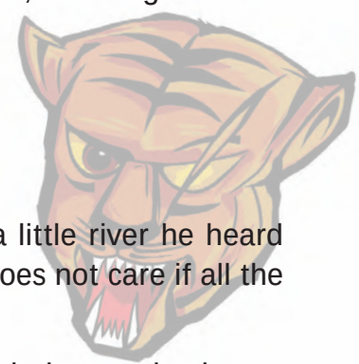

: (Angrily) He has no right to come here! By the law of the Jungle he has no right to change his quarters without due warning. If he comes here, he will frighten every head of game within ten miles and I – I have to kill for two, these days.


: (Quietly)His mother did not call him Lungri (the Lame One) for nothing. He has been lame in one foot from his birth. That is why he has only killed cattle. Now the villagers of the Waingunga are angry with him, and he has come here to make our villagers angry. They will scour the jungle for him when he is far away, and we and our children must run when the grass is set on fire. Indeed, we are grateful to Shere Khan!


: (Quietly) I go. You can hear Shere Khan below in the forest.



Scene II


: Father Wolf listened and below in the valley that ran down a little river he heard the dry, angry, whine of a tiger who has caught nothing and does not care if all the jungle knows it.


: The fool! To begin a night's work with that noise! Does he think that our bucks are like his fast Waingunga bullocks?


: Hush! It is neither bullock nor he hunts tonight. It is Man.


: The whine had changed to a sort of humming purr that seemed to come from every quarter of the compass. It was the noise that bewilders woodcutters and gypsies sleeping in the open, and makes them run sometimes into the very mouth of the tiger.


: Man! (Showing all his white teeth.) Hah! Are there not enough beetles and Man, and on our ground too!

Scene III


: The law of the Jungle, which never orders anything without a reason, forbids every beast to eat Man except when he is killing to show his children how to kill, and then he must hunt outside the hunting grounds of his pack or tribe. The real reason for this is that Man-killing means, sooner or later, the arrival of men on elephants with guns and rockets and torches. Then everybody in the jungle suffers. The reason the beasts give among themselves is that Man is the weakest and most defenceless of all living things, and it is true – that Man-eaters become mangy and lose their teeth. The purr grew louder, and ended in the full-throated howl.


: Aaarrh!


: Then there was a howl – an untigerish howl – from Shere Khan.


: He has missed.

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